WORKSHEET 1 OF 5

Building Scorecard

One sheet for each building. Copy this page.

> **Read before you score.** This is a first-look screen for an existing building that might suit a 1 to 10 MW data center. It ranks your list. It does not approve a building, and it does not replace the utility's written answer or a licensed engineer's finding. The weights, the cut points and the score bands are my estimates. They have no published source and have not been tested.

Building: _____ **Parcel no.:** _____ **Date:** _____

Serving utility (and source): _____ **Scored by:** _____

How to rate

Give each of the eleven lines one rating.

Rating	Meaning	Counts as
Good	The evidence meets the "good" description	The full weight
Maybe	In between, or a clue without confirmation	Half the weight
No-go	The evidence meets the "no-go" description	Zero
Unknown	You do not have the facts yet	Zero for now. Write U.

Write the evidence and its source beside every rating. A rating with no evidence is "unknown".

Gate 1. Power

1. Utility capacity, in writing (hard gate)

Weight 25

Good	Maybe	No-go
The utility confirms in writing 5 MW or more of total site load at this address, today or by a stated date	The utility confirms 1 to 5 MW in writing. Or a large service is installed and the utility has not yet answered	The utility states in writing that less than 1 MW is available, with no upgrade path or date

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 25

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

2. Installed service

Weight 10

Good	Maybe	No-go
5,000 kVA or more on the nameplates, or a substation on site that serves this parcel	1,500 to 5,000 kVA	Under 1,500 kVA

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 10

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

3. Distance to a substation of the serving utility

Weight 8

Good	Maybe	No-go
On site or next door, about a quarter mile or less	Within about 2 miles	More than about 2 miles, and no large service installed

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 8

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

Notes for this gate:

- Line 1 is total site load, not IT load.

- Line 2 measures equipment. kVA = 1.732 × volts × amps ÷ 1,000 for a three-phase service. kVA is not kW without power factor. A nameplate is not a promise from the utility. Do not add two services together.
- Line 3 is a clue about the work to connect. A nearby substation proves neither service nor spare capacity. Record which map you used and its date.

Gate 2. Permits

4. Zoning (hard gate) — Weight 10

Good	Maybe	No-go
The code lists the use, or a use that plainly covers it, as allowed by right in this district	The use needs a special or conditional approval. Or the code does not name it and staff must interpret	The use is prohibited, or a recorded restriction blocks it

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 10

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

5. Flood designation — Weight 5

Good	Maybe	No-go
Building and yard outside the mapped Special Flood Hazard Area	Part of the yard is in a mapped flood hazard area, or the area is mapped as moderate risk	The building itself is in a mapped Special Flood Hazard Area

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 5

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

6. Neighbors and water		Weight 4
Good	**Maybe**	**No-go**
Industrial or vacant neighbors, and a cooling design that uses little water	Homes in sight but buffered by distance or a road. Or water use not yet known	Homes or a school at the property line. Or a design that needs a large new water withdrawal

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 4

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

Notes for this gate:

- Line 4: copy the exact words of the listed use from the code.
- Line 5: a flood designation is a flag for review, not a rejection. A "no-go" here scores zero on this line. It does not fail the building.
- Line 6: low water use is not an automatic exemption from any permit.

Gate 3. Structure

7. Floor type and the engineer's finding (hard gate)		Weight 12
Good	**Maybe**	**No-go**
A licensed structural engineer has reviewed the floor and the delivery path for the intended rack layout and found them suitable, in writing	Slab on grade, not yet reviewed. Or an elevated floor awaiting an engineer's review	A licensed structural engineer has found the floor unsuitable and strengthening not feasible

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 12

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

8. Clear height		Weight 5
Good	**Maybe**	**No-go**
16 feet or more	12 to 16 feet	Under 12 feet

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 5

Evidence, source and date _____

Notes for this gate:

- Line 7 asks two things: what kind of floor is it, and what has an engineer found? Write the floor type and the source. Do not write a pounds-per-square-foot figure as a pass or a fail. A floor's code design load cannot be compared with a rack's weight to pass or fail a building.
- Until an engineer has reported, the best rating on line 7 is "maybe". Only an engineer's finding makes it "good" or "no-go".
- Line 8: ask each buyer for its own minimum.

Gate 4. Cooling

9. Yard for cooling and generators (hard gate)		Weight 10
Good	**Maybe**	**No-go**
Open yard the owner controls on two or more sides, with truck access and no homes adjoining	Yard on one side only. Or equipment would have to go on a roof that an engineer must check	No yard the owner controls, and an engineer has found no workable roof or other route

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 10

Evidence, source and date _____

Note for this gate: a mechanical engineer sizes the plant. You are recording whether there is anywhere to put it.

Gate 5. Connectivity

10. Fiber carriers and routes — Weight 7

Good	Maybe	No-go
Two or more carriers confirm fiber to the building, entering by different routes	One carrier with fiber. Or two that may share a route. Or map listings and markers only	Carriers confirm no fiber at or near the address

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 7

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

Note for this gate: the FCC map reports mass-market internet service. A listing does not prove data center connectivity, and a missing listing does not prove there is no fiber. Only a carrier's written response makes this line "good" or "no-go".

After the gates. The owner

11. Owner and title — Weight 4

Good	Maybe	No-go
One decision maker, open to a sale or a lease, who shares bills and drawings	Interested but slow. Several owners. Or wants a price before facts	A title dispute. Another party already holds rights. Or the owner will share nothing

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 4

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

Questions to carry

For the owner

- Can we read the main switchgear and transformer nameplates together?
- Can I see electric bills from the busiest year, showing peak demand?
- Do you have the original structural drawings or a slab report?
- What was the heaviest equipment on this floor, and did it have its own foundation?
- Which outdoor areas are inside your property line and free of easements?

- Are there recorded use restrictions, easements or covenants on the parcel?
- Has the building or yard ever flooded?
- Which carriers have equipment in your telecom room?
- Who else has to agree before you can sell or lease?

For the utility, from the owner or with the owner's written permission

- What capacity can you serve at this address today without new construction?
- What would it take, and how long, to serve the amount we need?
- Which substation and feeder serve this address?

For a buyer

- Is your megawatt figure IT load or total site load?
- What minimum clear height do you need?
- Does your cooling design evaporate water?
- Which network hub must the site reach?

Score

Sum of (weight × rating value) for all eleven lines	_____ out of 100
Number of lines rated Unknown	_____
Any hard gate (lines 1, 4, 7, 9) rated No-go?	Yes / No

How to read it. These bands are my estimates.

- **A hard gate rated no-go:** the building fails that gate, whatever the total. Write down the reason and the source.
- **75 or more:** a strong candidate. Next: the utility's answer in writing, and engineers.
- **50 to 74:** worth a site visit. Next: resolve every "maybe", starting with power.
- **Under 50:** set aside for now. Keep it on a second list.

Always report the score with the count of unknowns. A low score with many unknowns means you do not have the facts yet. It does not mean the building is poor. At a desk, lines 1, 7 and 10 can rarely be better than "maybe", so a first score is usually low.

Do not turn the result into a count of problems. One fatal problem can end a project. Several fixable ones need not.

> **This score is not an approval.** Nothing on this page states capacity, feasibility, value or a pass. The serving utility confirms power in writing. Licensed engineers decide what the building can carry and cool. Local officials decide what is permitted.